

COMPARISON · SPLIT · STRUCTURE

before-after

Explicit state-change comparison — what was, what is.

What writing decisions down actually changed.

BEFORE .

Decisions lived in the room they were made in. Six months on, nobody could say why we killed the project — only that someone senior had felt strongly. Every quarter relitigated the same three debates from memory.



AFTER .

Every decision is logged with its signals, its options, and the bet it made. We still relitigate, but now there is a record showing we already decided this in March. We ignore it, but faster.

Three reasons we are building.

BUILD

The platform is the product. Owning it owns the roadmap.



WHY NOT BUY

No vendor matches our compliance posture without surrender of control.

WHY NOT DELAY

Cost of waiting compounds: each quarter spent on workarounds is one fewer quarter on the platform.

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When NOT to reach for before-after.

Two competing options. Use `compare-prose` or `split-compare` when both sides are alternatives under consideration. before-after is for a change that already happened.

More than two states. If there is a middle state or a sequence of changes, use `list-steps` to show the progression. before-after is binary by construction.

Editorial labels on the cards. The card label is always Before or After. Renaming them to Old way / New way defeats the universal grammar and breaks reader expectations.

See also.

RELATED COMPONENTS

`compare-prose` — two alternatives being weighed, not a transformation

`split-compare` — binary decision with a verdict bar

`redline` — the change is in verbatim text, not structural state

`list-steps` — the change has more than two phases